



What about the Training Institutes?



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There was a time when every college kid worth his salt was clamouring to sign up for ‘a three year degree in computer science’ which promised to set you up for the rest of your life with a career you could only dream of. You just had to look up on almost any street to find a huge hoarding that advertised the latest course from a private computer institute that guaranteed to transform your life.

Just collect the keys to that BMW on your way out, was the underlying message.

As a result of fewer opportunities in the IT industry and considerable insecurity created by the shutting down of several fly-by-night computer institutes, most people are a lot more wary of empty promises.

It is pretty obvious that every one of these computer institutes delivered much less than they promised, despite their much touted training methodologies and supposedly world-class facilities. So many of us spent the best part of three years sitting in classes being taught Visual Basic by someone who had no more real world experience in programming than us. Or being taught how to become designers by someone who just barely understood the R, G and B of colour. Instead of giving us the valuable education that we expected after spending tens of thousands of rupees, these institutes provided little more than some course material and a certificate of debatable value and recognition.

But where does the major share of the blame lie? With those who made every thing sound so simple or with those of us who chose to believe that life could be so easy?

Most successful IT professionals will assure you that they learnt almost everything useful that they know at their workplace. Die-hard computing enthusiasts will tell you that they learnt much more by themselves at home while fiddling with a PC than they did at any computer class.

Which should be reason enough to avoid blindly entrusting someone else with your future. Instead, strive yourself to ensure that you get a real education that is based upon practical experiences.

Unless computer institutes can find a way to provide students with a considerably more stimulating environment than they currently do, it is unlikely that they will be able to regain the popularity they enjoyed.

They need to move beyond handing out empty certifications and towards delivering a wholesome education.

Karan Manral

Karan Manral
Assistant Editor
karan_manral@jasubhai.com